

The Lord of Pain — Rakdos Poisoned-Gift Group Slug

Bracket 4 · 6 Game Changers · Exquisite Blood + Sanguine Bond loop · 100 cards · built 2026-08-23, lifegain pass same day · Bracket 3 variant = 4 swaps (see swap page)

Lands 34 (33 tap for mana; 10 basic incl. 4 fetches, 3 MDFC)		Mana sources 42 (34 lands + 8 rocks; 41 actually tap — Glacial Chasm doesn't)			
Cost reducers Jet + Ruby Medallion, Rakdos		Avg MV 3.22	Creatures 22	Gifts 6	Draw-punishers 7
Cast/upkeep/mana punishers 5		Amplifiers 6	Lifeline 5	Removal + wipes 7 + 3	Protection 7
Game Changers 6 (B4) / 3 (B3)		Win conditions 5			

COMMANDER (1)

1 The Lord of Pain  5

LANDS (34)

1 Command Tower 
1 Blood Crypt 
1 Badlands 
1 Bloodstained Mire
1 Marsh Flats
1 Polluted Delta
1 Verdant Catacombs
1 Wooded Foothills
1 Dragonskull Summit 
1 Sulfurous Springs 
1 Blackcleave Cliffs 
1 Luxury Suite 
1 Graven Cairns 
1 Tainted Peak 
1 Smoldering Marsh 
1 Haunted Ridge 
1 Blazemire Verge 
1 Foreboding Ruins 
1 Mount Doom 
1 Urborg, Tomb of Yawgmoth 
1 Cabal Coffers 
1 Witch's Clinic 
1 Reliquary Tower 
1 Ancient Tomb 
1 Glacial Chasm
1 Malakir Rebirth 
1 Fell the Profane 
1 Bloodsoaked Insight 
2 Swamp 
4 Mountain 

RAMP & COST REDUCTION (12)

1 Sol Ring  1
1 Mana Vault  1
1 Grim Monolith  2
1 Mox Diamond  0
1 Dark Ritual  1
1 Arcane Signet  2
1 Rakdos Signet  2
1 Talisman of Indulgence  2
1 Fellwar Stone  2
1 Jet Medallion  2
1 Ruby Medallion  2
1 Rakdos, Lord of Riots  4

CARD DRAW — YOURS (2)

1 Valgavoth, Harrower of Souls  4
1 Jeska's Will  3

TUTORS (2)

1 Demonic Tutor  2
1 Vampiric Tutor  1

PROTECTION & DEFENSE (6)

1 Swiftfoot Boots  2
1 Mithril Coat  3
1 Deflecting Swat  3
1 Kaya's Ghostform  1
1 Hexing Squelcher  2
1 No Mercy  4

REMOVAL (7)

1 Terminate  2
1 Bedevil  3
1 Infernal Grasp  2
1 Rakdos Charm  2
1 Chaos Warp  3
1 Feed the Swarm  2
1 Deadly Rollick  4

BOARD WIPES (3)

1 Blasphemous Act  9
1 Toxic Deluge  3
1 Fraying Omnipotence  5

GIFTS — THE POISONED GENEROSITY (6)

1 Howling Mine  2
1 Font of Mythos  4
1 Temple Bell  3
1 Spiteful Visions  4
1 Seizan, Perverter of Truth  5
1 Descent into Avernus  3

DRAW PUNISHERS (6)

1 Underworld Dreams  3
1 Fate Unraveler  4
1 Kederekt Parasite  1
1 Sheoldred, the Apocalypse  4
1 Razorkin Needlehead  2
1 Orcish Bowmasters  2

CAST / UPKEEP / MANA PUNISHERS (5)

1 Kaervek the Merciless  7
1 Vial Smasher the Fierce  3
1 Painful Quandary  5
1 Mogis, God of Slaughter  4
1 Manabarbs  4

AMPLIFIERS (6)

1 Solphim, Mayhem Dominus  4
1 Torbran, Thane of Red Fell  4
1 Spiked Corridor  8
1 Twinflame Tyrant  5
1 Bloodletter of Aclazotz  4
1 Wound Reflection  6

LIFELINE (5)

1 Exquisite Blood  5
1 Bloodthirsty Conqueror  5
1 Sanguine Bond  5
1 Basilisk Collar  1
1 Whip of Erebos  4

WIN CONDITIONS (5)

1 Torment of Hailfire  2
1 Exsanguinate  2
1 Gray Merchant of Asphodel  5
1 Wheel of Fortune  3
1 Heartless Hidetsugu  5

Build history — 7 substitutions made to finalize this list

IN 	Basalt Monolith {3} Doesn't untap during your untap step. {T}: Add {C}{C}{C}. {3}: Untap this artifact.	Grim Monolith {2} Doesn't untap during your untap step. {T}: Add {C}{C}{C}{C}. {4}: Untap this artifact.	OUT 
Why: BRACKET 3 SWAP. Game Changer. Basalt is the same card one mana up, with a {3} untap instead of {4}.		Bring back: Any Bracket 4 table.	
IN 	Imp's Mischief {1}{B} Change the target of target spell with a single target. You lose life equal to that spell's mana value.	Vampiric Tutor {B} Search your library for a card and put it on top. Lose 2 life.	OUT 
Why: BRACKET 3 SWAP. Game Changer, and B3 wants tutors sparse. The redirect behind Deflecting Swat.		Bring back: Any Bracket 4 table.	
IN 	Leechridden Swamp land Swamp; enters tapped. {B},{T}: each opponent loses 1 life (needs two black permanents).	Glacial Chasm land Prevent all damage that would be dealt to you. Cumulative upkeep — pay 2 life. Sacrifice a land on entry; creatures you control can't attack; no mana.	OUT 
Why: BRACKET 3 SWAP. Glacial Chasm is on the Game Changers list.		Bring back: Any Bracket 4 table.	
IN 	Mind Stone {2} {T}: Add {C}. {1}, {T}, Sacrifice this artifact: Draw a card.	Mana Vault {1} Doesn't untap during your untap step. At the beginning of your upkeep, you may pay {4} to untap it. At the beginning of your draw step, if tapped, it deals 1 damage to you. {T}: Add {C}{C}{C}.	OUT 
Why: BRACKET 3 SWAP. Game Changer. Mind Stone is the non-GC 2-drop that cashes in for a card late.		Bring back: Any Bracket 4 table.	
IN 	Shadowspear {1} Equipped creature gets +1/+1, trample, lifelink. {1}: opponents' permanents lose hexproof and indestructible. Equip {2}.	Sanguine Bond {3}{B}{B} Whenever you gain life, target opponent loses that much life.	OUT 
Why: BRACKET 3 SWAP. Bond + Exquisite Blood (or + Bloodthirsty Conqueror) is a two-card infinite; taking Bond out removes both loops. Shadowspear is a second lifelink equipment for the commander.		Bring back: Any Bracket 4 table.	
IN 	Swamp land Basic.	Ancient Tomb land {T}: Add {C}{C}. Deals 2 damage to you.	OUT 
Why: BRACKET 3 SWAP. Game Changer.		Bring back: Any Bracket 4 table.	

IN



Thought Vessel {2}

You have no maximum hand size. {T}: Add {C}.



Mox Diamond {0}

If this would enter, you may discard a land card instead. If you do, put it onto the battlefield. If you don't, put it into its owner's graveyard. {T}: Add one mana of any color.



OUT

Why: BRACKET 3 SWAP. Game Changer. Vessel is a second no-max-hand-size effect behind Reliquary Tower, which matters at 6+ draws a turn.

Bring back: Any Bracket 4 table.

Sideboard — what to bring in, and when



Archfiend of Despair {6}{B}{B}

Bring in: Second Wound Reflection for long Coffers games. Displaces Wound Reflection or runs alongside.



Bloodchief Ascension {B}

Bring in: Grindy pod — arms in 3 end steps, then 2 per card into their graveyard (14 per wheel). Displaces Seizan.



Bojuka Bog —

Bring in: Reanimator pod — a second graveyard exile behind Rakdos Charm. Enters tapped. Displaces Mana Vault.



Bolt Bend {3}{R}

Bring in: Third redirect behind Deflecting Swat; costs {R} with the commander out. Single-target spells only. Displaces Mox Diamond.



Brash Taunter {4}{R}

Bring in: Creature-heavy pod — Taunter + Blasphemous Act is 13 (x2 Solphim) to one player. Displaces Fraying Omnipotence.



Burning Inquiry {R}

Bring in: 1-mana wheel-lite: 3 draws × punishers per opponent. Displaces Fraying Omnipotence.



Chandra, Awakened Inferno {4}{R}{R}

Bring in: Enchantment-removal-heavy pod; emblems can't be answered. Displaces Manabarbs.



Court of Ambition {2}{B}{B}

Bring in: Grindy pod; 3 life or discard per upkeep, monarch baits attacks away. Displaces Manabarbs.



Imp's Mischief {1}{B}

Bring in: Combo/counter-heavy pod — second redirect, spells only, costs life = MV (already the B3 Vampiric swap). Displaces Vial Smasher.



Kardur, Doomscourge {2}{B}{R}

Bring in: Go-wide attackers; goad + drain. Displaces No Mercy.



Kefka, Dancing Mad {5}{B}{R}

Bring in: 'I cast your cards and you pay for them' finisher. Displaces Heartless Hidetsugu.



Leechridden Swamp land

Bring in: B3 tables (Glacial Chasm is a Game Changer), or when the 35th land must tap for mana. Displaces Glacial Chasm.



Lightning Greaves {2}

Bring in: You need haste+shroud more than self-targeting (Coat attach, Collar equip, Witch's Clinic). Displaces Swiftfoot Boots.



Master of the Feast {1}{B}{B}

Bring in: Pure 'here, have a card' 5/5 flier. Displaces Dark Ritual.



Ob Nixilis, the Hate-Twisted {3}{B}{B}

Bring in: 8th draw-punisher that is also removal. Displaces Manabarbs.



Scrawling Crawler {3}

Bring in: Grindy pod with no amplifier in sight — its 1 life per opponent draw is life loss, which Solphim/Torbran/Torture Pit cannot multiply, so its value collapses exactly when the deck is winning. Displaces Grim Monolith.



Stormfist Crusader {B}{R}

Bring in: Low-curve pod; 2-drop gift/ping. Displaces Seizan.



Tempting Contract {4}

Bring in: You want the Treasure gift back (bigger opposing spells → bigger Lord/Kaervek hits). Displaces Rakdos, Lord of Riots.



Wild Evocation {5}{R}

Bring in: Chaos table — forced free cast each upkeep triggers Lord/Kaervek/Quandary. Displaces Seizan.



Mana Flare {2}{R}

Bring in: Table where the extra mana poisons them more than it helps them. It gives three opponents what it gives you. Displaces Dark Ritual.



Mindcrank {2}

Bring in: B4 only — infinite with Bloodchief Ascension (bring both) at 3 counters. Displaces Fraying Omnipotence + Seizan.



Repercussion {1}{R}{R}

Bring in: Opponents creature-heavy, you are not: Blasphemous Act = 13 × their creatures to each of them. Displaces Fraying Omnipotence.



Shadowspear {1}

Bring in: Second lifelink equipment for the commander (already the B3 Sanguine swap). Displaces No Mercy.



Teferi's Puzzle Box {4}

Bring in: Chaos-friendly, counter-light tables — hand+3 punished draws per player per turn; you can't hold answers past your draw step. Displaces No Mercy.



Wheel of Misfortune {2}{R}

Bring in: A second true wheel. Displaces Fraying Omnipotence.



Withering Torment {2}{B}

Bring in: Extra enchantment answer (Leyline of Sanctity blanks the commander). Displaces Feed the Swarm.

Every amplifier is opponent-only on purpose: the gift engines are symmetric, so a Fiery Emancipation would triple Spiteful Visions' pings on YOU. Your own damage comes back: Basilisk Collar/Whip of Erebos lifelink on the pingers, Glacial Chasm prevents all damage to you. One opponent draw under Solphim + Torture Pit with six punishers = 27. Replacement ordering is the damaged player's choice (CR 616.1): (1×2)+2+2 = 6, never (1+4)×2. Full math in research/formulas.md, pilot notes in research/gameplan.md.

THE LORD OF PAIN — GAMEPLAN (FOR THE PILOT)

What the deck is

A Rakdos group-slug deck that *looks* like group hug. You hand the table extra cards, extra mana, free Treasures and a fresh hand every turn — and every one of those gifts is billed: each draw, each spell, each upkeep, each land tapped. The commander is the cashier: every player's first spell each turn deals its mana value to a **player you choose** (anyone but the caster), and nobody on the other side can gain life back.

Mulligan

Keep a 7 with 3+ lands (or 2 lands + a rock/Medallion) **and** at least one of: a draw-punisher (Kederekt Parasite, Razorkin Needlehead, Underworld Dreams, Sheoldred, Fate Unraveler, Bowmasters), a gift engine (Howling Mine, Spiteful Visions, Font, Temple Bell), or a Medallion. One early play is enough; two is a snap-keep.

The dream 7: land, land, Sol Ring or a Medallion, Kederekt Parasite or Razorkin, Spiteful Visions or Howling Mine, one removal/protection spell, anything. That curves rock → 2-drop punisher → Lord on 3 → gift on 4, and the bill starts on turn 4.

The fast-mana openers (added 2026-09-22). T1 Mana Vault off any land puts the **Lord on turn 2** (2 lands + ). T2 Grim Monolith gets there on 3 with your land drop still up. Mox Diamond wants a land in hand — at 34 lands that is usually fine, but don't keep a 2-lander on the strength of it. Dark Ritual is best spent on a 4-drop engine piece two turns early, not held for a finisher. All the self-damage (Vault's draw-step 1, Ancient Tomb's 2) is **erased by Glacial Chasm** while the mana still happens — CR 615.6 for the prevention, 605.3b for Tomb's mana ability resolving anyway.

Ship it if: 1 land; 5+ lands with no engine piece; or a hand that is all amplifiers/finishers (Torbran, Solphim, Wound Reflection, Torment, Hidetsugu) with no punisher — those cards do nothing until the punishers are down. Amplifiers are the *second* thing you deploy, never the first.

6-card keeps are fine with 2 lands + rock + one engine piece; this deck draws 3+ extra a turn once an engine is out, so a slightly light hand recovers.

Tutors — what to get (Demonic Tutor, Vampiric Tutor)

Ask, in order: *what is missing from [punisher + gift + protection]*? Fetch the missing third.

Board state	Get	Why
No draw-punisher down yet	Sheoldred, the Apocalypse	Best single card: punishes, and pays you 2 per draw (the lifeline). Second choice Spiteful Visions (gift + punish in one).
Punishers down, no gift	Font of Mythos (or Howling Mine if mana-tight)	Turns 1 draw a turn into 3 — triples every punisher.
Punishers + gift down, table is healthy	Solphim, Mayhem Dominus	Doubles everything noncombat; the first amplifier is the one that matters.
Commander keeps dying / removal-heavy pod	Mithril Coat (flash, indestructible) or Kaya's Ghostform	The engine's single point of failure is the Lord.
Under attack / going wide at you	No Mercy or Toxic Deluge / Blasphemous Act	Stabilise first; the engine wins the long game.
Exquisite Blood (or Conqueror) already out, any drain live	Sanguine Bond	Ends the game on the next point of life lost. The reverse (Bond out → get Exquisite) is the same.
A doubler is out (Solphim / Twinflame)	Heartless Hidetsugu	Every even life total dies, odd go to 1; add Torbran and everyone dies.
Bloodletter out, 9 mana available	Fraying Omnipotence	Each opponent loses their whole life total.
Punishers out, big mana turn coming	Wheel of Fortune	7 draws × punishers per opponent. Cast Bloodletter first.
Flooding on mana, nothing to do	Torment of Hailfire (with Cabal Coffers/Urborg)	X × 3 per opponent, 6 under Bloodletter.

Vampiric Tutor puts the card on top: cast it in your end step (or in response to a Teferi's Puzzle Box trigger — the normal draw happens before draw-step triggers, so a tutored card gets bottomed otherwise). Never tutor an amplifier before a punisher, and never tutor a gift before a punisher — the gift alone is pure group hug.

Sequencing

1. **T1-2:** rock / Medallion / Kederekt / Bloodchief / Razorkin. Kederekt needs a red permanent:

a Medallion-less T1 Parasite comes online with Razorkin, Spiteful, the Lord, Torbran, Solphim.

1. **T3:** The Lord under both Medallions, or (Tomb/Sol Ring) on curve at 5. Cast the commander

before the first symmetric gift if you can — the gift is only a gift once the bill exists.

1. **Order of gifts:** Spiteful Visions first (it punishes as it gives), then Howling Mine / Font /

Temple Bell once two draw-punishers are down. **Teferi's Puzzle Box last** — only with ≥2 draw-punishers out, ideally Sheoldred or Exquisite Blood too (it shuffles your own hand every turn and Spiteful pings you per draw; Sheoldred pays you 2 per draw).

1. **Amplifiers after payoffs.** Solphim/Torbran/Torture Pit with nothing on board are blanks; with

three punishers out each one roughly doubles the clock. Bloodletter is for **your** turn (wheels, Torment, Exsanguinate, Fraying Omnipotence); Wound Reflection is for theirs.

1. **Temple Bell** timing: tap it in an opponent's end step (they draw into Sheoldred/Dreams with no main phase to use the card) or in response to a wipe.

1. **Kaervek** is the biggest single swing after the Lord — it is 5 under both Medallions. Point its damage at creatures when a blocker matters and at faces otherwise.

Where to aim the Lord

- The trigger targets "another" player than the caster: when Alice casts, hit Bob or Carol; when you cast, hit whoever is ahead. Use it to **keep the table even** — the deck wins long games.
- Opponents with Leyline of Sanctity / Aegis of the Gods / Shalai can't be targeted by it — kill the enchantment (Feed the Swarm, Chaos Warp) or route damage to the others.
- Your own first spell each turn triggers it too (and Vial Smasher at a random opponent): cast a cheap spell precombat every turn even if it is just a Signet — 2 damage is 6 under amplifiers.

Staying alive

- Exquisite Blood / Bloodthirsty Conqueror: every point the table loses comes back to you. Under either, the symmetric pieces (Spiteful Visions, Descent, Manabarbs, Seizan, Hidetsugu) are net positive for you.
- Sheoldred +2 per card you draw; under Mine+Font that is +6 a turn.
- Basilisk Collar on the commander from the turn it lands (1 + equip 2): every trigger is life. Whip of Erebos makes every pinger lifelink — under Whip, Heartless Hidetsugu is a net lifegain for you.
- Glacial Chasm: drop it when the table turns on you or once 3+ symmetric pieces are out; sacrifice a tapped/colourless land to it. Pay 2, 4, 6... — let it go when the upkeep outgrows the prevention.
- Witch's Clinic: 2 to give the commander lifelink for a turn if Collar is gone.
- No Mercy + a 5/5 menace blocker. The table *will* decide you are the problem around turn 5 —

hold Deflecting Swat / Mithril Coat for the commander, not for a punisher. **Note the No Mercy / Glacial Chasm anti-synergy:** under a Chasm no creature ever deals damage to you, so No Mercy never triggers (CR 615.6, 603.2g). Pick one shield per board state; don't rely on both at once.

- Exile-based graveyard hate is **Rakdos Charm** only (Bojuka Bog went pocket 2026-09-22); bring the Bog back for a known reanimator pod.

Kill lines (in order of how often they happen)

1. **Attrition** — three punishers + Font/Mine: ~12 per opponent per turn, doubled by the first amplifier, doubled again at end step by Wound Reflection. Most games end here by turn 8–9.
1. **Wheel turn** — Wheel of Fortune with the punishers out: 7 draws × punishers per opponent. Cast Bloodletter first.
1. **Heartless Hidetsugu** + Solphim/Twinflame (even totals die, odd go to 1) or + Torbran as well (everyone dies). Haste via Swiftfoot Boots.
1. **Bloodletter + Fraying Omnipotence** — each opponent loses half ×2 = all. 9 mana.
2. **Torment of Hailfire / Exsanguinate** with Cabal Coffers/Jeska's Will/Monolith mana; Gray Merchant for 10+ each.
1. **Exquisite Blood + Sanguine Bond** (B4) — tutor the second half with Demonic/Vampiric once the first is down and any drain is live.

What beats you

- **Enchantment wipes / Farewell** — the engine is enchantments and artifacts. Don't overextend punishers into a known Farewell player; two punishers + one amplifier is enough.
- **Leyline of Sanctity** (you can't target them), **counterspells on the commander** (Hexing Squelcher, Swat), **Torpor Orb-style stax** (Font/Mine don't care).

- **Aggro turning on you early** — No Mercy or Glacial Chasm (not both — see above), keep Deadly Rollick/Terminate for the biggest attacker, and remember the Lord's trigger can point the caster's own spell damage at whoever is attacking you.

- **Your own symmetric pieces** — never run a symmetric multiplier (Fiery Emancipation etc.), never

a "players can't gain life" card; decisions.md explains why.

THE LORD OF PAIN — FORMULAS

All damage-replacement ordering is chosen by the **damaged opponent** (CR 616.1): they always pick the order that hurts least. Multipliers commute; additives (+2) are applied *after* a multiplier in the opponent's chosen order. So with Solphim (×2) + Torbran (+2) + Torture Pit (+2) a 1-damage ping becomes **(1 × 2) + 2 + 2 = 6**, never (1 + 4) × 2 = 10.

One opponent draw costs...

Draw-punishers on board: Underworld Dreams, Kederekt Parasite, Razorkin Needlehead, Fate Unraveler, Orcish Bowmasters (not the first draw-step draw), Spiteful Visions = 6 × 1 **damage**; Sheoldred (2) = 2 **life loss** (not multiplied by damage effects; Scrawling Crawler, the other un-multipliable point, went pocket 2026-09-22).

Board	Per draw	Draws/turn/opp under Mine+Font+Visions (+natural) = 5	+ Temple Bell + Seizan = 8
punishers only	6 + 2 = 8	40	64
+ Solphim	12 + 2 = 14	70	112
+ Solphim + Torture Pit	(1×2+2)×6 + 2 = 26	130	208
+ Torbran too (Razorkin, Visions are red)	26 + 2×2 = 30	150	240
× Wound Reflection at end step	×2	—	—

You will rarely have all seven. **Three punishers + Font + Mine is already 3 × 4 = 12 a turn per opponent** with no amplifier; two amplifiers make it lethal within a turn cycle.

The commander's trigger

Expected first-spell MV ≈ 3. Four triggers a turn cycle (each player's first spell), all aimed by me. Under Solphim + Torbran + Torture Pit: (3 × 2) + 4 = **10 per trigger**, ~40 a round, placed where it hurts most. Under Twinflame Tyrant too: 3 × 2 × 2 + 4 = 16. Kaervek adds MV again for **every** opponent spell.

Heartless Hidetsugu

Hidetsugu deals [life/2] to each player (me included — not doubled, every amplifier is opponent-only).

Opp life	alone	+ Solphim or Twinflame (×2)	+ Torbran (+2)	×2 and +2
40	20 → 20 left	40 → dead	22 → 18	min(42, 42) → dead
21	10 → 11 left	20 → 1 left	12 → 9	min(22, 24) → dead
15	7 → 8 left	14 → 1 left	9 → 6	min(16, 18) → dead

Rule: **a doubler kills even life totals and leaves odd ones at 1; doubler + additive kills everything at 2+ life** (a player at exactly 1 would be dealt 0, which is no damage at all — CR 120.8). Activate with Swiftfoot Boots haste the turn he lands, or hold him until a doubler is out. I take half my own life — be above 10 and have Exquisite Blood / Conqueror out if possible (each opponent's half comes back to me).

Bloodletter of Aclazotz kills

Bloodletter doubles life **loss** during my turn. "Lose half, rounded up" ×2 = all of it:

- **Fraying Omnipotence** (5 MV): every opponent loses their whole life total. 9 mana total.
- Torment of Hailfire X: each repetition is 6 not 3 (if they don't sac/discard).
- Exsanguinate X: 2X each, I gain 3X (→ Sanguine Bond for 3X more).
- Gray Merchant: 2 × devotion each.

Exquisite Blood + Sanguine Bond

Any opponent life loss → I gain that much (Exquisite) → target opponent loses that much (Bond) → repeat. The loop only needs one opponent to lose 1 life; Bond's target is re-chosen each trigger, so it kills the table one player at a time. Bloodthirsty Conqueror is a second Exquisite. The commander's "opponents can't gain life" does not touch my gain (CR 119.9). **Bracket 4 only** — see SIDEBORD.md for the Bracket 3 derivation.

Life coming back (Collar / Whip / Chasm)

Lifelink on the commander (Basilisk Collar) gains the trigger's damage: ~4 triggers a turn cycle at 3–10 each = 12–40 life a round, more under amplifiers (lifelink reads the damage *after* replacements, CR 120.4b–c). Whip of Erebos extends that to every creature pinger; Hidetsugu under Whip hits you for [L/2] and gives back the three opponents' halves — net strongly positive. Glacial Chasm prevents all damage to you (not life loss: Seizan's 2 and Infernal Grasp's 2 still land) for 2-n life on your n-th upkeep — 2+4+6+8 = 20 life over four turns; sacrifice it when that outgrows what it prevents.

Manabarbs and the self-tax

Manabarbs hits every player's land taps. Me: ~5 taps a turn = 5 damage a turn, not multiplied. Opponents: ~5 taps each, $\times 3 = 15$, **3 per tap under Torbran** (red source) = 45 a round. Mana Flare doubles what a tap yields but not the number of taps, so it sweetens the gift without raising my own bill. With Exquisite Blood out the net is +40 for me a round; under Glacial Chasm my own bill is 0.

Commander cost

3   = 5. Jet Medallion (black spells -1) **and** Ruby Medallion (red spells -1) both apply (it is both colours) → 1   = 3. Each recast adds 2 tax; Kaya's Ghostform returns it for  instead.

Gray Merchant devotion (black pips on permanents in the list)

Lord 1 · Underworld Dreams 3 · Bloodletter 3 · Sheoldred 2 · Conqueror 2 · Sanguine Bond 2 · Painful Quandary 2 · Exquisite Blood 1 · Wound Reflection 1 · Kederekt 1 · Fate Unraveler 1 · Seizan 2 · Kaervek 1 · Valgavoth 1 · Mogis 1 · Spiteful Visions 2 (hybrid pips count) · Bloodchief 1 · Gray Merchant 2. A mid-game board of six of these is devotion 10–12: 30+ life drained across the table, 10+ gained, Sanguine Bond fires again for the gain.